

## A2

## GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST TENSES

# Past Continuous

Actions in progress at a moment in the past: was / were + -ing.

Şimdiki Zamanın Hikayesi

## QUICK UNDERSTANDING

Past Continuous, **geçmişte belirli bir anda devam etmekte olan** bir eylemi anlatır. Türkçedeki "-yordu" ekiyle (yapıyordum, okuyordu, koşuyorlardı) örtüşür: olay o anda tamamlanmamış, sürüyordu.

## The Structure

### Formula

**I / He / She / It + was + fiil-ing**

**You / We / They + were + fiil-ing**

was/were seçimi özneye göre değişir; fiile her zaman -ing eklenir.

### Affirmative / Negative / Question

#### AFFIRMATIVE

I/He/She/It + was + V-ing

You/We/They + were + V-ing

They were waiting outside.

#### NEGATIVE

Subject + wasn't/weren't + V-ing

She wasn't listening to me.

#### QUESTION

Was/Were + subject + V-ing?

Were you sleeping at midnight?

### Word Order

Özne — was/were — fiil-ing — (nesne). while/when cümleleri virgülle veya bağlaçla iki eylemi birbirine bağlar.

- **While I was walking** home, it started to rain. — Eve yürürken yağmur yağmaya başladı.
- **I was watching** TV **when** she arrived. — O geldiğinde televizyon izliyordum.

## How It Works

### When do we use it?

- **Başka bir olay tarafından kesilen eylemler için:** I was cooking when the phone rang.
- **Bir hikayenin arka planını çizmek için:** The sun was shining and birds were singing.
- **while ile aynı anda süren iki eylem için:** While Mert was driving, Elif was checking the map.
- **when + Past Simple ile ani bir olayın devam eden bir eylemi kesmesi için:** She was sleeping when the earthquake started.

### When DON'T we use it?

**Tek seferlik, tamamlanmış bir olay için Past Continuous KULLANMA** — bunun için Past Simple gerekir.  
✗ I was going to the market yesterday and bought some bread. → ✓ I went to the market yesterday and bought some bread.  
**state (durum) fiillerini -ing ile KULLANMA:** ✗ I was knowing the answer. → ✓ I knew the answer.

## Short Answers

Yes, I was. / No, I wasn't. — Yes, they were. / No, they weren't.

**Not:** -ing kısa cevaplarda tekrar edilmez, sadece was/were kullanılır.

## Türkçe Mantığı

### Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Saat 9'da ders çalışıyordum." → O AN EYLEM SÜRÜYOR MUYDU? → Evet, saat 9'da devam ediyordu, tam bitmemiştii → HANGİ ZAMAN? → Past Continuous (was/were + -ing) → CÜMLE → "I was studying at 9 o'clock."

## Examples

### TEMEL KULLANIM

- I was reading a book at 8 o'clock last night. — Dün gece saat 8'de kitap okuyordum.
- They were playing basketball in the park. — Parkta basketbol oynuyorlardı.
- She wasn't listening to the teacher. — Öğretmeni dinlemiyordu.

### KESİLEN EYLEMLER (WHEN)

- I was taking a shower when the doorbell rang. — Kapı zili çaldığında duş alıyordum.
- He was driving to work when he saw the accident. — İşe giderken kazayı gördü.
- We were having dinner when the lights went out. — Işıklar söndüğünde yemek yiyorduk.

### AYNI ANDA SÜREN EYLEMLER / ARKA PLAN

- While Zeynep was cooking, Mert was setting the table. — Zeynep yemek pişirirken Mert masayı hazırlıyordu.
- The wind was blowing hard and the sea was rough. — Rüzgar sert esiyordu ve deniz dalgalıydı.
- Were you working late last night? — Dün gece geç saatlere kadar çalışıyor muydun?
- What were you doing at this time yesterday? — Dün bu saatte ne yapıyordun?
- The children were making a lot of noise while their parents were talking. — Ebeveynleri konuşurken çocuklar çok gürültü yapıyordu.

## Compare & Notice

### Compare With

| Past Continuous                                                                | Past Simple                                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Devam eden, sürmekte olan bir eylem — bir çizgi gibi.<br>I was cooking dinner. | Tamamlanmış, bitmiş bir olay — bir nokta gibi.<br>I cooked dinner. |

→ Past Continuous vs Past Simple konusuna git

### Visual Timeline

**Timeline:** eylem geçmişte başladı · o anda devam ediyordu (belki başka bir olay onu kesti)

## Common Mistakes

✗ I was going to school and I met my friend on the way.

✓ I went to school and I met my friend on the way.

**WHY?** Tamamlanmış, tek seferlik bir olay için Past Simple gerekir; Past Continuous ancak devam eden bir eylem başka bir olayla kesiliyorsa uygundur.

✗ I was knowing him very well.

✓ I knew him very well.

**WHY?** "know" gibi durum (state) fiilleri -ing ile kullanılmaz; bu fiiller doğrudan Past Simple ile kullanılır.

✗ They was watching a movie.

✓ They were watching a movie.

**WHY?** "they" ile "were" kullanılır, "was" değil — özneye göre was/were seçimi Türkçede karşılığı olmadığı için sık karıştırılır.

✗ When I was arriving, she left.

✓ When I arrived, she was leaving. / When I arrived, she had already left.

**WHY?** "when" ile gelen kısa, ani eylem genelde Past Simple ile kurulur; kesilen/uzun süren eylem Past Continuous olur — ikisi karıştırılmamalı.

## Practice

Name: \_\_\_\_\_

Date: \_\_\_\_\_

Score: \_\_\_\_\_ / 17

### PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. They \_\_\_\_\_ a movie at 9 p.m. yesterday.

- a) was watching      b) watched at      c) were watching      d) are watching

2. I \_\_\_\_\_ dinner when the phone rang.

- a) cooked      b) were cooking      c) was cooking      d) am cooking

3. Find the mistake and correct it.

I <sup>A</sup> was knowing <sup>B</sup> him very well. <sup>C</sup>

Correction: \_\_\_\_\_

### PART B · PRACTICE

4. While Mert \_\_\_\_\_, Elif was checking the map. (drive)

5. The sun \_\_\_\_\_ and the birds were singing. (shine)

6. What \_\_\_\_\_ you doing at 10 o'clock last night?

- a) are      b) was      c) were      d) did

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

She <sup>A</sup> were sleeping <sup>B</sup> when the earthquake started. <sup>C</sup>

Correction: \_\_\_\_\_

8. Your friend asks why you didn't answer the phone. You were in the shower.

What do you say?

- a) Sorry, I had a shower when.  
b) Sorry, I was having a shower.  
c) Sorry, I am having a shower.  
d) Sorry, I was have a shower.

9. "At 7 a.m. I was running in the park." What does it mean?

- a) The running started before 7 and continued after 7.  
b) I started running exactly at 7.  
c) I will run at 7.  
d) I ran every day at 7.

### PART C · FINAL CHECK

10. It \_\_\_\_\_ when we left the house.

- a) was raining      b) were raining      c) is raining      d) rained a

11. We \_\_\_\_\_ TV when the lights went out.

- a) watched      b) watch      c) was watching      d) were watching

12. \_\_\_\_\_ you sleeping when I called? (be)

**13.** Find the mistake and correct it.

They <sup>A</sup> was playing <sup>B</sup> football in the rain. <sup>C</sup>

Correction: \_\_\_\_\_

**14.** While I \_\_\_\_\_, I heard a strange noise.

- a) am walking home      b) was walking home      c) walked home was      d) were walking home

**15.** You tell a story.

Which is the best opening?

- a) It is a cold night, and the wind blew.  
b) It was a cold night, and the wind was blowing.  
c) It was a cold night, and the wind were blowing.  
d) It was a cold night, and the wind is blowing.

**16.** Make it negative: "He was listening to the teacher."

He \_\_\_\_\_ to the teacher.

**17.** "I was reading when she arrived." Which action started first?

- a) arriving  
b) They started at the same time.  
c) reading  
d) We can't know.

## Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

### PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **c) were watching** — They ile were + V-ing.
2. **c) was cooking** — Kesilen, süren eylem → was cooking.
3. **B — was knowing → knew** — know durum fiilidir → past simple.

### PART B · PRACTICE

4. **was driving** — While + aynı anda süren iki eylem → past continuous.
5. **was shining** — Hikâyenin arka planı → past continuous.
6. **c) were** — You ile were: What were you doing?
7. **B — were sleeping → was sleeping** — She ile was.
8. **b) Sorry, I was having a shower.** — O anda süren eylem → was having.
9. **a) The running started before 7 and continued after 7.** — Past continuous, o anda devam eden eylemi anlatır.

### PART C · FINAL CHECK

10. **a) was raining** — Arka planda süren eylem → was raining.
11. **d) were watching** — We ile were + V-ing.
12. **Were** — Soru: Were you sleeping?
13. **B — was playing → were playing** — They ile were.
14. **b) was walking home** — While + past continuous.
15. **b) It was a cold night, and the wind was blowing.** — Hikâye arka planı → past continuous: the wind was blowing.
16. **He wasn't listening to the teacher.** — Olumsuz: wasn't + V-ing.
17. **c) reading** — Past continuous eylem (reading) önce başlamıştı; arrived onu kesti.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırılmalar):  
<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/a2/past-continuous>